

KY.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document a Kentucky owner-builder meets — what each one is, when it is needed, and which office it comes from.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Kentucky writes one mandatory residential code for the whole state — and then leaves the building permit, the inspections and the certificate of occupancy to each of its 120 counties and its cities, some of which require them and many of which do not. The state plumbing permit and the electrical certificate of approval apply either way. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. State form names below are the Department's. Local forms vary, and in much of Kentucky there is no local form at all — the obligations behind the state ones do not change either way.

Documents a Kentucky owner-builder will encounter

Document	What it is and when you need it	Where it comes from
County inspector sheet	Not a form — the lookup . One page per county naming your state electrical inspector, plumbing inspector and their office hours, HVAC inspector, health department environmentalist, and whether a local building inspector exists at all. When: first, before anything else. Free.	dhbc.ky.gov → HOW DO I? → Contact an Inspector
On-site sewage disposal construction permit	The septic permit, on form DFS-307 , preceded by a site evaluation the health department must complete in 15 working days . By statute it must accompany your state plumbing permit application if you are on a system without surface discharge — so this is the long pole. There is no separate operation permit; there is an inspection before backfill. When: before the plumbing application, and ideally before the house is sited.	County health department, under the Cabinet for Health and Family Services
Homeowner septic installation	You may install your own system. The permit issues to a homeowner if you apply first and personally perform all the work — except excavation and backfill, which a certified installer may do <i>only if you name them on the application</i> . One homeowner septic permit per person per five years , repairs excepted. Not available if you are building for sale or resale.	Part of the septic permit application

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Water well: certified driller and a filed well record	The one trade a Kentucky homeowner may not do themselves. It is unlawful to construct, alter or repair a water well without a state driller's certificate, and there is no homeowner exemption — the contrast with electrical, plumbing, HVAC and septic is stark. No permit to drill is required; the controls are the certified driller, the well record filed with the state, and a bacteriological test on a potable well.	A certified water well driller; record filed with the Division of Water
State plumbing installation permit application	Filed with the Department, not your county — unless a local government has been authorized to issue, in which case its permit <i>"shall be deemed a permit issued by the department."</i> Must be applied for before work begins , with plans and specifications of the plumbing and of the water supply system.	Department of Housing, Buildings and Construction, Division of Plumbing
Homeowner plumbing affidavit	Filed <i>with</i> the plumbing application: your sworn statement that you will abide by 815 KAR Chapter 20. The permit is issued only to a licensed master plumber or to a homeowner meeting all five conditions — including that all the work be personally performed by you .	Part of the plumbing permit application
Plan Application Form	The plumbing plan-review form incorporated by reference into the regulation (edition 2/2020), submitted with three identical sets of plans where plan review applies. Ask whether your house needs this at all — see KY.2.	Division of Plumbing
HVAC Construction Permit Application: Homeowner One & Two Family Dwellings	One of four named HVAC application forms, and the one you use. Applied for before the HVAC work starts .	Department of Housing, Buildings and Construction
HVAC homeowner filings	Three things go in with that form: an affidavit to abide by the regulation, proof of adequate sizing of the system, and a complete design plan of all related duct and piping . The heaviest paperwork of the three trades.	Part of the HVAC permit application
Electrical final certificate of approval	Issued by a certified electrical inspector . Not optional and not skippable: without it <i>"no utility shall initiate permanent electrical service to any new building."</i> When: at the end of the electrical work, before you expect permanent power.	Certified electrical inspector — local, or the state inspector on your county sheet

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Local building permit application	Only where your city or county passed an ordinance requiring permits for single-family dwellings. Wholly a local instrument — form, plan requirements and fees are all set locally. When: after zoning and the health department are lined up.	Your city or county building department, if it has one
Workers' compensation and unemployment affidavit	Required by statute before any Kentucky building department or political subdivision may issue a permit: your sworn assurance that every contractor and subcontractor is in compliance. Penalty is \$4,000 or the sum of all uninsured claims, whichever is greater.	Part of the local permit application
Certificates of insurance from subcontractors	Not a government form — the evidence behind the affidavit you just signed. Collect one from every sub before they start and check the expiry against your schedule.	Each subcontractor's insurer
Construction documents and site plan	Plans to the 2018 Kentucky Residential Code, Third Edition. Required with a local building permit application; worth drawing properly regardless, because the code binds your house whether or not anyone reviews the drawings.	You or your designer
Zoning approval / setback confirmation	A separate question from building permits, and not answered by them. Many Kentucky counties have zoning and no building permit, or the reverse. Get setbacks in writing before you draw .	City or county planning, or the county judge/executive
911 address assignment	You will need an address before a utility will open an account. When: early — it is quick, and it blocks things if left late.	County 911 / emergency services office
Driveway or entrance permit	An encroachment or entrance permit where the driveway meets a state-maintained route; otherwise the county road department. Confirm which authority owns your road before assuming.	Kentucky Transportation Cabinet district office, or the county
Floodplain permit	A state permit, and the statute names buildings expressly: no one shall " <i>place a building, barrier, or obstruction of any sort in, any area in the floodplain or floodway</i> " without the cabinet's approval. It opens " <i>notwithstanding any other provision of law</i> " and is not conditioned on any local ordinance — so it applies in full even in a county with no building permit. Plans must be drawn by a licensed engineer unless the cabinet waives it. When: before you buy, if you can.	Energy and Environment Cabinet, Division of Water — eec.ky.gov

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Certificate of occupancy	Required before occupancy where a local government has established jurisdiction; not required for a single-family dwelling where it has not . Request one anyway if you can — without it, a later code-violation award against you may add reasonable attorney's fees, for up to ten years.	Your local building official, where one exists

WHAT NEEDS NO PERMIT AT ALL

Kentucky's exemptions are narrow and specific. Each exempts you from the **permit** only — never from the code, and never from zoning.

- **Plumbing:** no permit for the repair of **leaks, cocks or valves**, or for **cleaning out waste or sewer pipes**. Everything else on the list in the regulation — a new installation, moving a fixture or waste opening, a new or replaced house sewer or water service, adding a backflow preventer, a new or replaced water heater — does need one. (815 KAR 20:050 §1(1), (3))
- **HVAC:** *"No permit or inspection shall be required for the installation of **window unit air conditioners or space heaters**,"* and none is required at all *"except in buildings designed for human occupancy"* — which a house is. The permit requirement reaches the **initial** system; replacement equipment is permitted and inspected on request under a separate provision. (KRS 198B.6671(5), (6); 815 KAR 8:070 §1(1), §3(1))
- **Farmsteads:** *"This chapter shall not apply to farmsteads"* — the plumbing chapter, in terms. This is a real carve-out and it is frequently over-read; it does not touch the building code, the electrical certificate of approval, or the health department's septic rules. Ask before you rely on it. (KRS 318.015(3))
- **Farm buildings in an urban-county government:** an urban-county government *"may determine service districts within their boundaries within which farm dwellings and other farm buildings, not used in the business of retail trade or as a place of regular employment for ten (10) or more people, shall be exempt from the requirements of the Uniform State Building Code."* This is permissive and geographically narrow — check whether your urban-county government has actually done it. (KRS 198B.060(3))

The exemption that is not on this list

You will not find a general Kentucky exemption for small detached accessory buildings, decks, or fences of the kind most states publish in their code's permit-exemption section. That is because in much of Kentucky the question does not arise: where no local ordinance requires a building permit for the house itself, there is nothing for a shed to be exempt *from*. Where an ordinance does apply, the exemptions are **that jurisdiction's** and you have to ask for them.

The trade permits are the constant. A detached garage you run power and a hose bib to still touches the electrical certificate of approval and the plumbing permit, whatever your county says about the building.

Local permit exemptions confirmed with: _____ Date: _____

Sources (verified August 2026; statutes and regulations at apps.legislature.ky.gov, forms and county sheets at dhbc.ky.gov). Plumbing permits, what needs none, the homeowner conditions and the Plan Application Form (2/2020) — 815 KAR 20:050 Sections 1, 2 and 7. The state plumbing permit and the septic permit that must accompany it — KRS 318.134(1)(a), (2). Local authorization and deemed department permits — KRS 318.140(1). Farmsteads — KRS 318.015(3). The four HVAC application forms and the homeowner filings — 815 KAR 8:070 Sections 1(2), 2(2), 3(1). Window units, space heaters and buildings designed for human occupancy — KRS 198B.6671(5), (6). The workers' compensation affidavit — KRS 198B.060(10). The electrical certificate of approval and permanent service — KRS 198B.060(11). Certificates of occupancy — KRS 198B.060(13); attorney's fees where none was issued — KRS 198B.130. Urban-county farm building exemption — KRS 198B.060(3). On-site sewage construction permit, the DFS-307 form, the homeowner permit and its five-year limit — 902 KAR 10:085 Section 2 and 902 KAR 10:110 Sections 1(8), 2(4) and 3; the fifteen-working-day site evaluation — KRS 211.350(3). Water well drillers must be certified and there is no homeowner exemption — KRS 223.405 and 223.425(3); well records — KRS 223.440. State floodplain permit for placing a building in a floodplain — KRS 151.250(2), with the engineer requirement at KRS 151.260(2).